



Photograph Deepak Verma

Each month *Digit* will carry a caption for a photo. Come up with something funnier, and beat the *Digit* team at their own game! Entries accepted by the 20th of this month.

Beat That!

Digit Caption

Road Rash, anyone?

Last Month's Winner!

Abdul Khader J, Hyderabad
"That's what Crysis did to my laptop"



E-mail your caption with the subject "Beat That", and your postal address, to beatthat@thinkdigit.com and win

1 Hour Web Site
by Utvich, Milhous
and Beylinson

Published by

WILEY-INDIA



another site and do the same all over again...

A group of companies that believe in securely sharing predefined user data across the Internet is promising to change all that. Their Web site, www.DataPortability.org, encourages online companies to leverage existing technologies to share user data across other Web sites. What this means is that you won't have to re-enter details (like interests) or upload photographs all over again on that new Web site you just signed on to.

Leading developers from Google and Facebook, among many others, have recently agreed to take part in this path-breaking project.

For you, the end user, this means an Internet that is completely personalised to your interests and tastes, with all your data and relationships seamlessly accessible, while saying bye-bye to your privacy. If the industry pundits can

put aside their differences and work with participating members, the privacy angle can be sorted out, though.

These are, of course, early days, with companies only just having signed on. We'll keep our eyes and ears open on this one.

NIGERIAN SCAM?

OLPC Sued In Nigeria

LANCOR, a Nigerian manufacturer of lingual keyboards, has accused the OLPC Foundation of infringing on intellectual proprietary rights from two of its products. It claims that the OLPC purchased two of LANCOR's keyboards—and reverse-engineered its XO keyboards to be more like the KB-201s. Although the company shows no proof, it expects the OLPC to pay \$20 million (Rs 80 crore).

The company's lawyers responded swiftly to the

charges, asking for clarifications on details of the keyboard that LANCOR claimed had been infringed upon. Instead of communicating with the lawyers, LANCOR filed a Motion on Notice in the federal high court of Lagos, which stopped the OLPC Foundation from donating its laptops in the country. The court has slapped a temporary injunction on LANCOR, and this stops the company from closing a \$1 million (Rs 2 crore) order with the Nigerian government.

Some believe there is actually an Intel (under)hand in all this. They believe that the Motion of Notice allows Intel enough time to convince the Nigerian government to choose the Classmate PC, a small PC similar to the OLPC's XO and designed for kids, instead of the OLPC laptops. These rumours have gathered more ground with Intel recently having distanced itself from the OLPC foundation.

SCIENTIFIC SORTING

Google Gets Science-y

Search (and other things) giant Google is all set to store the world's open source scientific data at domain <http://research.google.com>. The project has been dubbed Palimpsest. Since the data will be open source, it will be accessible by all—scientists and non-professionals alike. The project was set to be showcased at the Science Foo Camp—a science fair at the Google campus in August last year, but missed its deadline and is scheduled to be launched soon.

Since the amount of data it will host is vast, there are technological challenges like being able to transfer large volumes of data quickly to the end user. The company will leverage the data visualisation technology it acquired from Trendalyzer, and will offer algorithms on the site for